

The Bavarian Forest

A mixed mountain forest, dominated by spruce, fir, and beech, where plants and animals must contend with acidic soil, high rainfall, and months of cold winter weather



Southeastern Germany's Bavarian Forest covers the high region between the Danube River valley and the Bohemian Forest along Bavaria's border with the Czech Republic. Together, these two forests form Europe's largest area of continuous woodland. Bavarian Forest terrain consists mainly of tree-covered granite and gneiss hills and mountain domes, interspersed with valleys and elevated plains. Native spruce is the

dominant tree species, mixed with fir and beech; all must cope with the area's highly acidic, nutrient-poor soils. According to a local saying, the climate is "three-quarters winter and one-quarter cold," which aptly describes the annual average temperature range of 37–46°F (3–7.5°C). Depending on altitude, yearly precipitation is 43–98 in (1,100–2,500 mm), 30–40 percent of which falls as snow.



△ SEED SEEKER

The Eurasian red squirrel makes the most of the Bavarian Forest's plentiful supply of spruce seeds. It emerges just after sunrise to begin daily foraging.

Around **10,000 animal species** are believed to live in the Bavarian Forest

